The Lamb and the Sea

Exodus 12–15

The big idea: On the night of judgment God passed over every house marked with the blood of a spotless lamb. Then he opened the sea, and Israel walked through on dry ground. Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed.

Before you meet: Read

Exodus 12:1–13, 21–32 | Exodus 14:10–31 | 1 Corinthians 5:7

Open (5 minutes)

If someone asked you what Jesus' death means to you, what would you say?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Your lamb shall be without _____, a male a year old." *(Exodus 12:5)*

"The blood shall be a _____ for you, on the houses where you are. And when I see the blood, I will _____ you." *(Exodus 12:13)*

"The LORD will _____ for you, and you have only to be _____." *(Exodus 14:14)*

Discuss

1. The Israelite families were not better than the Egyptians. On Passover night the only question was, is there blood on the door? Why is that good news for people who know they are not good enough? *Exodus 12:13, 23*

2. Israel was saved by standing still and walking through on ground God dried. Where are you trying to save yourself instead of trusting God to fight for you? *Exodus 14:13–14*

3. Jesus took the bread and cup of the Passover and made them the Lord's Supper. How should remembering the Passover lamb shape the way you come to the table? *Luke 22:15–20*

Memory verse

"For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed."

1 Corinthians 5:7

Pray

Thank God that he hears the cry of people in slavery and comes down to rescue them. Name the sin that still enslaves you and ask the Son to set you free. Thank Jesus, the Lamb without blemish, for dying in your place.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 16

The Lamb and the Sea

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Exodus 12:1–13 and 14:13–22 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Exodus 19–20).

Main points to land

1. Israel was not spared for being better than Egypt. A lamb died in each marked house in place of the firstborn. God passed over because of the blood.
2. Israel did nothing to save themselves at the sea. They stood still and walked through. God does the rescuing, and his people receive it by faith (14:13–14; Hebrews 11:29).
3. Jesus is our Passover lamb (1 Corinthians 5:7). He gave the Lord's Supper at the Passover, and not one of his bones was broken (John 19:36). Only his blood answers for us on the day of judgment.

Core doctrine to teach

Redemption CORE DOCTRINE 8 OF 26

To redeem is to set a slave free by paying a price. God redeemed Israel from Egypt by the blood of the Passover lamb and the power of his arm. That rescue was a picture of a greater one: Christ redeems sinners from sin, death, and the devil by his own blood. *Exodus 6:6; 12:13; Mark 10:45; 1 Peter 1:18–19*

Answer key (Observe)

1. blemish
2. sign; pass over
3. fight; silent

Questions people will ask

How could a good God kill the firstborn, even children?

Do not rush past this. It is a terrible night, and Scripture means it to be. Pharaoh had drowned Israel's baby boys, and God warned him of this plague long before it came (4:22–23). Every house in Egypt and Israel deserved judgment, and Israel's firstborn lived only because a lamb died. Abraham asked, "Shall not the Judge of all the earth do what is just?" We trust that he does, and that he judged sin finally at the cross.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you that you hear the cry of slaves and come down to rescue them. Thank you for the Lamb without blemish, whose blood turns your judgment aside. Bring each of us under that blood. Where we are still slaves to sin, set us free, and give us the song of the redeemed: the LORD is our strength and our song, and he has become our salvation. In Jesus' name, Amen.